



## Finland



Finland's language and national identity have been influenced by both its Scandinavian and Russian neighbors. Once aligned with the USSR, Finland is now a member of the EU.

**GEOGRAPHY**

South and center are flat, with low hills and many lakes. Uplands and low mountains in the north. 60% of the land area is forested.

**CLIMATE**

Long, harsh winters with frequent snowfalls. Short, warmer summers. Rainfall is low, and decreases northward.

**PEOPLE & SOCIETY**

One in four of the population lives in the Greater Helsinki region. Swedish-speakers live mainly in the Åland Islands in the southwest. The Sámi (Lapps) lead a seminomadic existence inside the Arctic Circle. Women make up 48% of the labor force, continuing a long tradition of equality between the sexes. Families tend to be close-knit, though marriage is becoming less common.

**THE ECONOMY**

Strong engineering and electronics sectors: home of Nokia. Wood, pulp, and paper production.



**INSIGHT:** *Finland has Europe's largest inland waterway system*

**FACTFILE**

**OFFICIAL NAME:** Republic of Finland

**DATE OF FORMATION:** 1917

**CAPITAL:** Helsinki

**POPULATION:** 5.33 million

**TOTAL AREA:** 130,127 sq. miles  
(337,030 sq. km)

**DENSITY:** 45 people per sq. mile

**LANGUAGES:** Finnish\*, Swedish\*, Sámi

**RELIGIONS:** Evangelical Lutheran 89%, other 9%, Orthodox Christian 1%, Roman Catholic 1%

**ETHNIC MIX:** Finnish 93%, other (including Sámi) 7%

**GOVERNMENT:** Parliamentary system

**CURRENCY:** Euro = 100 cents